LOKALBOT · FILES · MAC

Find any file by what it says, shows or sounds like

Choose the folders LokalBot may read. It reads the documents, PDFs, pictures, screenshots, recordings and videos in them on your Mac, and Ask, Quick Recall and the Ask assistant can then find a file by what is in it, not only by its name. Nothing leaves your Mac.

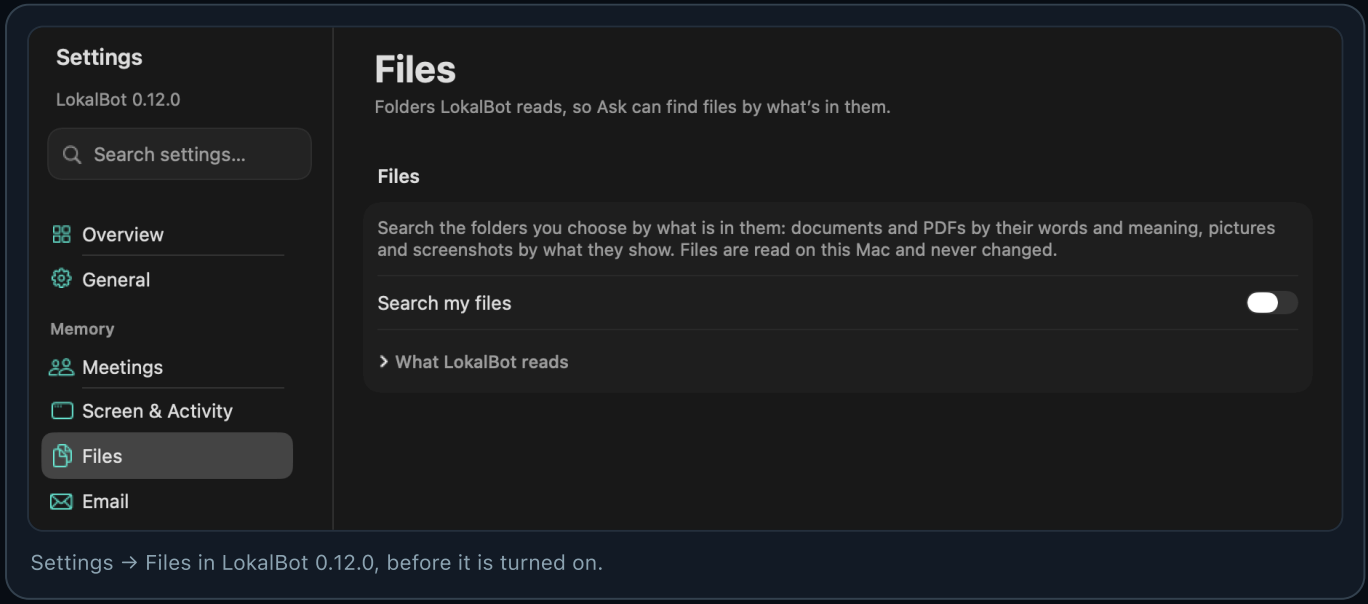
PDFs, page by page · Documents · Pictures · Screenshots · Recordings · Video

ASK FOR IT THE WAY YOU REMEMBER IT

`the clause about pets in the lease`	→	**The PDF**, opened at that page with your words marked
`a dog on the beach`	→	**The photo**, though nothing in it is named “dog”
`payment declined error`	→	**The screenshot** that showed it
`where they talk about sleep`	→	**The podcast**, playing from 12:34 in a LokalBot window
`INV-2041`	→	**The invoice**, by its exact words

Turn it on

1. Open **Settings → Files** and turn on **Search my files**. A notice says what LokalBot will read before anything is read.
2. Click **Documents**, **Desktop** or **Downloads**, or **Add Folder...**. A sheet counts what the folder holds and shows how long its first read takes on your Mac, how big the index gets, and any model download still to come. Nothing is read until you click **Add**.
3. Search in **Ask** or **Quick Recall**. Files appear after meetings and screen moments, and **Sources → Result type → Files** shows only files. Ask the assistant a question and it searches your files too and cites the one it used.



Settings → Files in LokalBot 0.12.0, before it is turned on.

What LokalBot reads

READS, ONLY IN THE FOLDERS YOU LIST

- Pictures and screenshots, by what they show and the text in them.
- PDFs page by page, and documents such as txt, md, rtf, docx, odt and html. A long one is read 30 pages first, and the rest follows in later passes.
- Recordings and video, unless **Include recordings and video** is off: sound 30 seconds at a time, video a frame per shot.

SKIPS

- Hidden folders, app bundles and caches.
- Code projects, except the screenshots in them.
- Folders that look like datasets.
- iCloud files that aren't downloaded.

What stays on your Mac

YOUR FILES

Read where they are, never copied, moved or changed.

THE INDEX

Each file's path, its text, and a vector of what it says, shows or sounds like, in the LokalBot library. About 3 KB a picture and 8 KB a PDF page.

NETWORK

None for your files. The model LokalBot reads with downloads once, 555 MB for its image part the first time.

COMPUTE

The model runs only while new or changed files are read and stops 2 minutes later. Reading pauses while a meeting records, in Low Power Mode and while the Mac is warm.

BATTERY

A folder's first read waits for a charger unless **Read big folders on battery** is on. New files are still read.

TURNING IT OFF

Turning off **Search my files** deletes the index. Removing a folder removes its files from it.

Screens by what they showed

With **Settings → Screen & Activity** set to **Text + visual context** and **Settings → Ask → Enable search by meaning** on, each screenshot LokalBot keeps also gets a vector of its picture. Screen search then finds a screen by what it showed, not only by its text.

External agents, if you allow it

Off by default. In **Settings → External Agents**, turn on reading your LokalBot data and tick **Files** (the Files page has the same box). Agents such as Claude Code or Codex can then search your files by their words with `lokalbot-cli search-files` or the MCP tool `search_files`.

Limits

Windows and Linux	Files came to both in 0.12.1. There, HEIC, AVIF and video frames need ffmpeg.
A heavy first read	A big folder takes minutes to hours the first time, depending on what it holds and your Mac; the Add Folder sheet shows the estimate. It runs in the background, slower while you work, and Settings shows about how long is left. While reading, the model uses about 0.9 GB of memory.
Hearing a moment	The assistant transcribes a matched recording moment only with a transcription model already on your Mac, and never while a meeting records. A remote transcription server gets the clip only if you approved it, as for meetings.
Not searched yet	Source code. Agents search files by their words, not their meaning.

- **Privacy policy:** lokalbot.com/privacy#files
- **Engine:** DigUp (MIT), github.com/ARahim3/DigUp